

# **English Technical Reports**

**Lectures Prepared By**

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# ***Chapter 2***

## ***Technical Report Designing***

# Objectives

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- To specify document designer Job.
- To present tips about document design.

# Topics covered

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- The jobs of document designers.
- The methods of analyzing the audiences.
- Four points should meet when tailoring a document to the reader.
- How to making the tailoring four points (**Designers Guidelines**).
- Four basic principles of document design.

# ***Document Design***

- **Why Should I Care?**
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If a document does not follow good design principles or suit an audience's needs, the purpose of the document's information will not be communicated effectively.

# ***Document Design***

- **The Job of the Document Designer:**

It is imperative that document designers catch the reader's attention visually and connect with readers' knowledge, experience, beliefs and values.

- **Analyzing the Audience**

- There are several perspectives from which a designer can try to anticipate the needs and expectations of the reader.

- This analysis is crucial, because sensitivity toward how readers might think and feel as they interact with a document ensures effective communication.

# ***Document Design***

- **Analyzing the Audience:**

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**Classifying Approach:** A profile of the target audience is constructed by brainstorming typical characteristics, listing facts from an outside perspective.

**Intuitive Approach:** By imagining a representative of the audience, designers can deliberate over what might fit the group.

# ***Document Design***

- **Analyzing the Audience:**
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**Feedback Approach:** Soliciting opinions from members of the actual audience group before beginning the actual design process can allow the designer to get a more precise starting point; a designer can learn how readers will interpret text, graphics, tone, and overall layout.



# ***Document Design***

- **A designer must accomplish:**
- 

**Designers must be sure to meet the following four points when tailoring a document to the reader:**

- Help readers search for the information they want from words and pictures/graphics.
- Ensure that readers will be able to interpret and understand the information after finding it.

# ***Document Design***

- **A designer must accomplish:**
- 

**Designers must be sure to meet the following four points when tailoring a document to the reader:**

- Make it easy for readers to generate connections between words and pictures/graphics.
- Be sure that readers will most likely be able to apply the information they have gained from the document.

# ***4 basic principles of document design:***

## **□ Proximity** **Tips for achieving Proximity:**

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- Group related items together so they are seen as one cohesive group rather than unrelated bits.

(Ex: Express information graphically by grouping it)

- Organization is the key.
- Be conscious of where your eye is going: where do you start looking; what path do you follow; where do you end up; after you've read it, where does your eye go next?

# ***4 basic principles of document design:***

## **□ Proximity :**

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- **Purpose:** To organize. Well organized documents are more likely to be read and remembered.
- ✓ **How to get it:** Squint your eyes slightly and count the number of visual elements on the page by counting the number of times your eye stops. If there are more than three to five items on the page, see which of the separate elements can be grouped together into closer proximity to become one visual unit.

# ***4 basic principles of document design:***

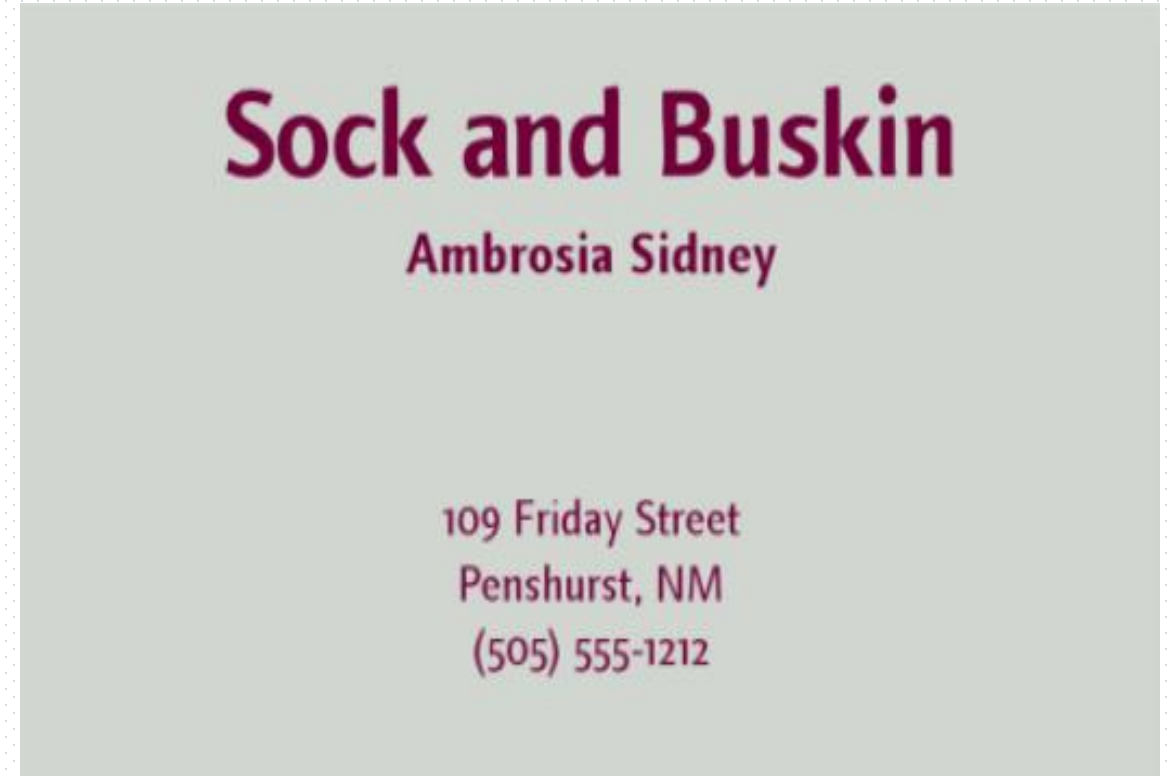
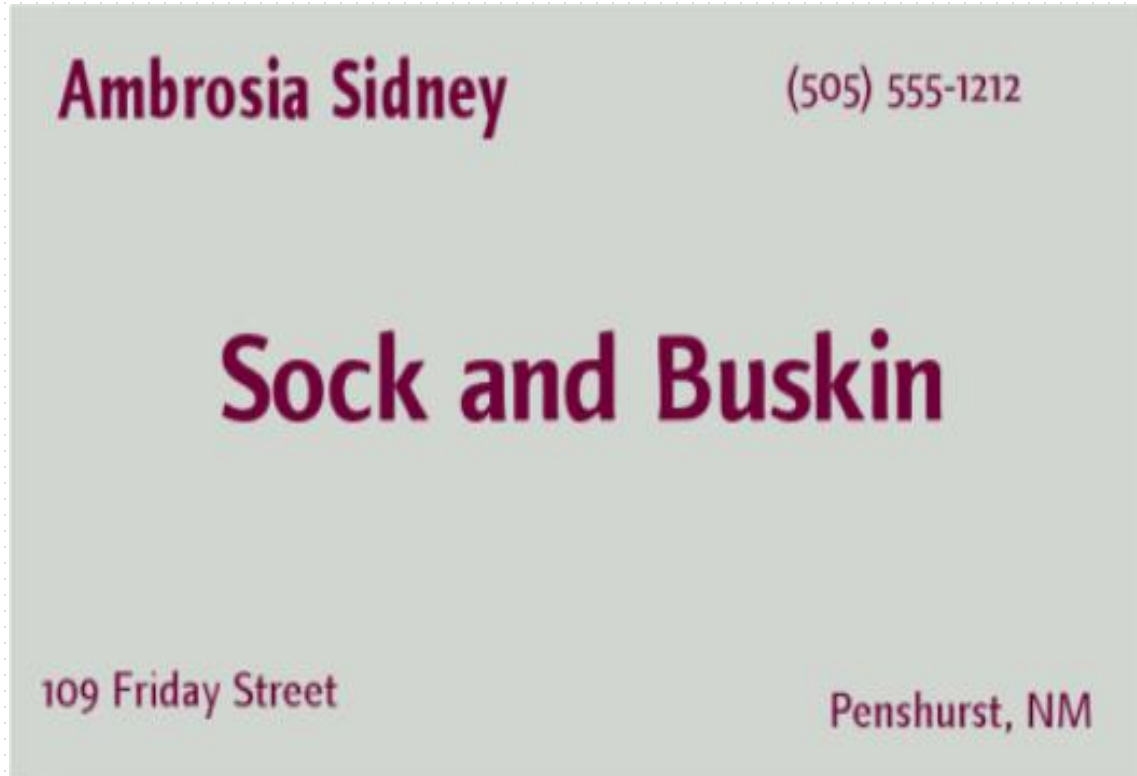
- × Proximity **What to avoid:**

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- Avoid too many separate elements on a page.
- Do not stick things in the corners and in the middle.
- Avoid leaving equal amounts of white space between elements unless each group is part of a subset.
- Don't create relationships with elements (headlines, subheads, captions, graphics, etc.) that do not belong together! If they are not related, move them apart from each other.

# ***4 basic principles of document design:***

## ☐ **Proximity :**

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# ***4 basic principles of document design:***

## **□ Alignment** **Tips for achieving Alignment:**

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- Nothing should be placed on the page arbitrarily.
- Every item should have a visual connection with something else on the page.
- Use strong left or right alignment.

# ***4 basic principles of document design:***

## **□ Alignment** **Tips for achieving Alignment:**

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- Make sure everything on the page has some visual alignment with another item on the page.
  - Find a strong line and stick with it--subtle lack of alignment is bad.
- (Ex: If you have a photo or a graphic with a strong flush side, align the flush side of text along the straight edge of the photo).



# ***4 basic principles of document design:***

## **□ Alignment :**

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➤ **Purpose:** To unify and organize the page.

✓ **How to get it:** Be conscious of where you place elements. Always find something on the page to align with, even if the two objects are physically away from each other.

# ***4 basic principles of document design:***

## × Alignment **What to avoid:**

- Avoid using more than one text alignment on the page.
- Stay away from centered alignment, unless you want to create a more formal, sedate look.

# ***4 basic principles of document design:***

## ☐ **Alignment :**

**Adding Alignment:**

|                                                     |                                                     |
|-----------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Document<br>Design<br>Bootcamp<br>Basics for<br>You | Document<br>Design<br>Bootcamp<br>Basics for<br>You |
| B <sup>3</sup> Associates                           | B <sup>3</sup> Associates                           |

**Before**

**After**

# ***4 basic principles of document design:***

## ❑ Alignment :

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Business Plan  
for  
The Shakespeare Papers

by Patricia Williams  
February 25

Business Plan  
for  
**The Shakespeare  
Papers**

by Patricia Williams  
February 25

# ***4 basic principles of document design:***

## **□ Repetition** **Tips for achieving Repetition:**

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- Repeat some aspect of the design throughout the entire piece – create consistency.  
(Ex: Bold headlines, bullets, graphics)
- Repetition helps organize.

# ***4 basic principles of document design:***

## **□ Repetition :**

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➤ **Purpose:** To unify and to add visual interest.

× **What to avoid:** Avoid repetition to the point of being overwhelming and annoying.

# ***4 basic principles of document design:***

## ✓ **Repetition** **How to get it:**

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- Repetition Be consistent.
- Push existing consistencies a little further.
- Look at possibilities of adding elements to create repetition.
- Find existing repetitions and strengthen them.
- Create repetitions to enhance the design and the clarity of the information.

# 4 basic principles of document design:

## □ Repetition :

Consistent double rule on all pages.

**Dam Honor Form**  
Heresy rheumatic starry offer former's dodder. Violate Huskings, an wart hoppings darn honor foam.  
Violate lift wetter fodder, oiled Former Huskings, hue hatter repetition for bang furry retch—an furry stretchy. Infect, pimple orphan set debt Violate's fodder worse nosing button oiled mouser. Violate, honor udder hen, wursted furry gnats parson—jester putty ladle form gull, sample, morticed, an unaffected.  
Wan moaning Former Huskings nudist haze dodder setting honor cheer, during nosing.

**Nor symphony**  
VIOLATE! sorted dode former, Watcher setting darn fur? Yore canned gat retch setting darn during nosing? Germ pup offer debt cheer!  
Arms tarred, Fodder, resplendent Violate warily.  
Watcher tarred fur, aster stretchy former, hoe dint half mush symphony further gull. Are badger dint doe mush woke disk moaning! Ditcher curry dose buckles fuller slob darn tutor peg-pan an feeder pegs?

**Vestibule guardings**  
Yap, Fodder. Are fetter pegs.  
Ditcher mail-car caws an swoop offer caw staple? Off curse, Fodder. Are mudet oiler caws an swapped offer staple, fetter checkings, an clammed upper larder inner checking-horse toe gadder oiler aches, an wen darn tutor vestibule guarding toe peck oiler bags an warms offer vestibules, an watched an earned yore closing, an fetter hearses an...  
Ditcher warder oiler hearses, toe? enter-ruptured oiled Huskings.  
Nor, Fodder, are dint. Dint warder war hearses? Wire nut?

Water rheumatic form!

Consistent typeface in headlines and sub-heads, and consistent space above each.

This single rule repeats across the bottom of each page.

Page numbers are in the same place (the bottom outer corners) and in the same typeface on each page.



# ***4 basic principles of document design:***

## **□ Contrast** **Tips for achieving Contrast:**

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- If two items are not exactly the same, then make them different—  
REALLY different.  
(Ex: Large type and small type or a horizontal element with a  
vertical element).
- Use larger font for headlines and bolder typeface.

# ***4 basic principles of document design:***

## **□ Contrast :**

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### **➤ Purpose:**

- To create an interest on the page.
- Aid in the organization of the information as well as the understanding of the reader.

# ***4 basic principles of document design:***

## **□ Contrast :**

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### **× What to avoid:**

- If you are going to add contrast, do it with strength.
- Avoid contrasting a sort-of-heavy line with a sort-of-heavier line.
- Avoid using two or more typefaces that are similar.

# ***4 basic principles of document design:***

## **☐ Contrast :**

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### **✓ How to get it:**

- Add contrast through your typeface choices: line thicknesses, colors, shapes, sizes, space, etc.
- Be strong!

# 4 basic principles of document design:

## ❑ Contrast :

### The Rules of Life

*Your attitude is your life.*

*Maximize your options.*

*Don't let the seeds stop you  
from enjoyin' the watermelon.*

*Be nice.*

### Adding Contrast:

|                                                         |                                                                      |
|---------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Document<br>Design<br>Bootcamp →<br>Basics for<br>You ↓ | <b>Document<br/>Design<br/>Bootcamp</b><br><i>Basics for<br/>You</i> |
| B <sup>3</sup> Associates<br>→                          | <b>B<sup>3</sup> Associates</b>                                      |

**Before**

**After**

# ***4 basic principles of document design:***

## **□ Integrating Text and Graphics:**

**Redundant:** Content of visual and verbal presentation is identical, stressing the repetition of key ideas.

**Complementary:** One medium dominates with main points while the other reinforces, elaborates or provides an example. May be used to clarify or expand how the reader construes main ideas.

# ***4 basic principles of document design:***

## **□ Integrating Text and Graphics:**

**Juxtaposition:** Content differs between the two; a key idea is revealed by the clashing of ideas. Full meaning is impossible to infer without both.

**Stage setting:** Through different content, one mode predicts the content, theme or main idea of the other medium, provides a context for what is to come.

# Key points

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- The jobs of document designer.
- Classifying Approach - Intuitive Approach - Feedback Approach.
- Four points when tailoring a document to the reader.
- Designers Guidelines.
- Proximity – Alignment – Contrast - Repetition.
- Ease of reading.
- Redundant – Complementary – Juxtaposition - Stage setting.